CHRIST (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), BANGALORE

Regulation for Prevention and Control of Ragging (Revised) 2019

POLICY

> CHRIST (Deemed to be University) shall be a ragging-free institution. Ragging in all its forms shall be completely banned in this Institution including in its departments, constituent units, all its premises (academic, residential, sports, kiosks, cafeteria, and the like) whether located within the campus or outside and in all means of transportation of students whether public or private. The Institution shall take strict action including but not limited to criminal proceeding and/or cancellation of admission against those found guilty of ragging and/or of abetting ragging, and subject to circumstances, the burden of proof may lie on the perpetrator of alleged ragging and not on the victim. The University is bound by the UGC Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions 2009 dated 17 June 2009, as Gazetted on 4 July 2009 and the amendments thereto from time to time.

REGULATION

This Regulation known as **'CHRIST (Deemed to be University) Regulation for Prevention and Control of Ragging (Revised) 2019'** as approved by the Vice Chancellor shall come into retrospective effect in replacement of the Christ University Regulation for Prevention and Control of Ragging 2009. This Regulation is intended for prevention, elimination, and control of the menace of Ragging in all forms on the students of the Institution whether within or outside its Campuses and to punish those who indulge in ragging.

1. WHAT CONSTITUTES RAGGING

For the purpose of this Regulation, 'Ragging' constitutes one or more of the following acts with or without intent to derive sadistic pleasure or showing of power, authority, or superiority by any student/s over any fresher or any other student:

1. Any conduct by any student or students whether by words spoken or written or by an act which has the effect of teasing, treating, or handling with rudeness a fresher or any other student.
2. Indulging in rowdy or undisciplined activities by any student or students which causes or is likely to cause annoyance, hardship, or psychological harm or to raise fear or apprehension thereof in any fresher or any other student.
3. Asking any student/s to do any act or to perform something which such student/s will not in the ordinary course and which has the effect of causing or generating a sense of shame or embarrassment so as to adversely affect the physique or psyche of any such student/s.
4. Any act by a student or students that prevents, disrupts, or disturbs the regular academic activity of a fresher or any other student.
5. Exploiting the services of a fresher or any other student by any student/s for completing one's own academic tasks.
6. Any act of financial extortion or forceful financial burden put on a fresher or any other student.
7. Any act of physical abuse including all variants of it such as sexual abuse, homosexual assaults, stripping, forcing obscene/lewd acts, gestures, causing bodily harm or any other danger to health or person.

8. Any act or abuse by spoken words, emails, post, public insults including deriving perverted/sadistic/vicarious pleasure from actively or passively participating in the discomfiture meted out to any fresher or any other student.
9. Any act that affects the mental health and self-confidence of a fresher or any other student.
10. Any act of physical or mental abuse (including bullying or exclusion) targeted at another student (fresher or otherwise) on the ground of colour, race, religion, caste, ethnicity, gender (including transgender), sexual orientation, appearance, nationality, regional origins, linguistic identity, place of birth, place of residence, or economic background.

2. DEFINITIONS

The terms used in this Regulation shall have the same meaning and connotation as has been defined under Clause 4 of the UGC Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions 2009 as amended from time to time except for what has been specifically provided herein:

1. **'Anti-Ragging Committee' (ARC):** Means the Anti-Ragging Committee formed and existing under this Regulation with jurisdiction over all the Campuses of the University.
2. **'Anti-Ragging Squad' (ARS):** Means the Anti-Ragging Squad formed and existing under this Regulation in every Campus of the University.
3. **'Campus':** Means the Campus of the University established within India and shall include the Nodal Office/s and such other establishments of the University and will mean to cover all its premises, departments, centres, libraries, canteens/cafeterias, workshops, playgrounds, gyms, sports areas, residences/hostels, and such other academic and non-academic locations.
4. **'Committee':** Committee or Enquiry Committee (by whatever name called) means and includes any Committee constituted by the Anti-Ragging Squad or by the Anti-Ragging Committee at the discretion to study or to enquire into any of the matters covered by or for the purpose of this Regulation.
5. **'Director of Student Affairs':** Means the Director of Student Affairs of the University.
6. **'FIR Case':** Refers to a case of Ragging which the Vice Chancellor of the University shall be mandated to file information with the local Police Station / Local Authority and shall include all cases of Ragging that fall under the category of cognizable offences as per the Criminal Procedure Code of India such as murder, rape, kidnapping, theft, etc., and will include penal cases (guided by its gravity or severity) relating to: (i) Abetment to ragging, (ii) Criminal conspiracy to rag, (iii) Unlawful assembly and rioting while ragging, (iv) Public nuisance created during ragging, (v) Violation of decency and morals through ragging, (vi) Injury to body causing hurt or grievous hurt, (vii) Use of criminal force, (viii) Assault as well as sexual offences or unnatural offences, (ix) Extortion, (x) Criminal trespass, (xi) Offences against property, (xii) Criminal intimidation, (xiii) Attempts to commit any or all of the above-mentioned offences against the victim(s), or (xiv) Physical or psychological humiliation. It will also include cases of Ragging that cause grievous hurt or injury as defined hereunder or that fall under the category of Ragging of Grievous nature.
7. **'Fresher':** Means a student who has been admitted to any course offered at CHRIST (Deemed to be University) in any of its Campuses and who is undergoing the first year of his/her study.
8. **'Grievous Injury':** Grievous hurt or injury shall have the same meaning as defined in Section 320 of the Indian Penal Code and includes Emasculation, Permanent privation of the sight of either eye, Permanent privation of the hearing of either ear, Privation of any member or joint, Destruction or permanent impairing of the powers of any member or joint, Permanent disfiguration of the head or face, Fracture or dislocation of a bone or tooth, or any hurt which endangers life or which causes the sufferer to be during the space of twenty days in severe bodily pain, or unable to follow his ordinary pursuits.
9. **'Institution':** Institution or University means CHRIST (Deemed to be University) and all its Campuses.

10. **'Penal Law':** Means Indian Penal Code, Criminal Procedure Code of India, and provisions of any other law that provide for punishment of offences of criminal nature.
11. **'Ragging of Grievous nature':** Means and includes such acts of ragging which causes deep/lasting mental or physical agony to the victim or that causes grievous injury. The acts of ragging stated in Sub-Clause (f), (g), and (j) of Clause 1 above depending on its severity may be treated as Ragging of Grievous nature.
12. **'Vice Chancellor':** Means the Vice Chancellor of the University.

3. AWARENESS DOCUMENTATION

1. The webpage and all admission-related brochures of the University shall carry a notice stating that ragging is completely banned, a criminal offence, and subject to strict disciplinary and legal action with the burden of proof lying on the perpetrator.
2. The notice shall be prominently displayed on Student Notice Boards across departments and designated locations.
3. Post-admission counselling/orientation for Freshers and inaugural addresses to seniors shall include a briefing on anti-ragging policies.
4. The University website shall provide permanent links to this Regulation and the UGC Regulations.
5. Application forms for admission and hostels shall require independent undertakings/affidavits by students and parents (Annexures 1(a), 1(b), and 1(c)).
6. Admission documentation shall mandate a Character and Conduct Certificate from the previous institution or a gazetted officer.
7. Reporting contacts for ragging incidents shall be published clearly on website portals, handbooks, and departmental notice boards.
8. All teaching and non-teaching personnel must be briefed on their mandatory duty to report any ragging incidents immediately to the Anti-Ragging Squad.

4. PREVENTION AND MENTORING

1. **Freshers Party:** Permitted only on working days under class teacher supervision with prior approval of the Director of Student Affairs.
2. **Teacher Reporting:** Class teachers must observe interactions and report any potential issues to counselors.
3. **Counseling:** Counselors must conduct general sensitization sessions on the ill effects of ragging.
4. **Hostel Monitoring:** Wardens must actively monitor inmate movements and record/report suspicious behavior.
5. **Hostel Restrictions:** Senior students are prohibited from visiting hostel rooms of freshers or inviting freshers to theirs without valid authorization.
6. **Mentoring Group:** Every class shall have an Anti-Ragging Student Mentoring Cell consisting of 10 students (including the Class Representative) holding regular monthly sensitization activities.

5. MONITORING / CONTROLLING COMMITTEES

(a) Anti-Ragging Committee (ARC): Headed by the Vice Chancellor (or Pro-Vice Chancellor). Includes representatives from Civil Administration, Police, Local Media, Youth NGOs, Parents, Teaching Faculty, Non-Teaching Staff, and both First-Year and Senior Students with equal gender representation. Holds final decision-making power regarding penalties and institutional response.

(b) Anti-Ragging Squad (ARS): Chaired by a Senior Professor. Conducts active surveillance, surprise raids, and immediate investigation into complaints. Submits findings within seven (7) working days to the ARC.

(c) Monitoring by Head of the Department: Department heads maintain an official Register of complaints and submit regular compliance extracts to Deans and the Director of Student Affairs.

(d) Anti-Ragging Monitoring Cell (ARMC): Functions under the Director of Student Affairs to compile statistics, track cases, and coordinate reports to the UGC.

6. DUTIES AND POWERS OF THE VICE CHANCELLOR

1. Mandated to file an FIR with the local Police Station within 24 working hours if an incident qualifies as an FIR case.
2. Appoints and reconstitutes the ARC and ARS.
3. Acts as the Appellate Authority, heading the independent Appellate Committee with casting vote authority in divided opinions.
4. Empowered to relax procedural time limits by up to three (3) working days for valid grounds.

7. PROCEDURE TO REGISTER COMPLAINTS

1. An affected student must lodge a written complaint in person or by university email within three (3) working days of the incident to the ARS, Director of Student Affairs, or HOD.
2. Parents/guardians may submit complaints on behalf of the student where justifiable.
3. Anonymous or improperly lodged submissions outside the prescribed channels will not be entertained.

8. PUNISHMENTS FOR RAGGING

Depending on gravity, punishments awarded by the ARC include:

1. Cancellation of admission.
2. Suspension from attending classes.
3. Withholding/withdrawing scholarship/fee concession and other benefits.
4. Debarring from appearing in tests/examinations or evaluation processes.
5. Withholding results.
6. Debarring from representing the University in competitions, fests, or sports.
7. Suspension/expulsion from hostel.
8. Rustication from the University for up to 4 semesters.
9. Expulsion and debarring from admission to any other institution.
10. Fine of up to Rs. 1,00,000/-.
11. Police FIR lodging for serious offences.
12. Collective punishment when perpetrators cannot be individually identified.

9. APPEAL PROCESS

Appeals against ARC decisions must be submitted in writing to the Vice Chancellor within two (2) working days of the order. Decisions on appeal are finalized within seven (7) working days and remain final and binding.

ANNEXURE 4: INDICATIVE PUNISHMENT FOR RAGGING

Clause	Nature of Ragging	Indicative Punishment
1 (a)	Teasing, treating, or handling with rudeness a fresher or any other student.	Suspension from classes up to 1 month; withholding scholarship/benefits; withholding results; debarring from tests/fests.
1 (b)	Rowdy/undisciplined activities causing annoyance, psychological harm, or fear.	Debarring from tests/events; withholding results; suspension/expulsion from hostel; rustication up to 4 semesters.
1 (c)	Forcing acts causing shame, embarrassment, physical or psychic distress.	Debarring from exams/events; withholding results; hostel expulsion; rustication up to 4 semesters; fine up to Rs. 50,000/-.
1 (d)	Disrupting regular academic activities of students.	Suspension from classes up to 1 month; withholding scholarship/results; debarring from examinations/events.
1 (e)	Exploiting services of freshers for completing one's own academic tasks.	Suspension up to 1 month; withholding scholarships/results; debarring from exams/ events.
1 (f)	Financial extortion or forceful financial burden.	Rustication up to 4 semesters; fine up to Rs. 1,00,000/-; cancellation of admission + **Mandatory FIR Case**.
1 (g)	Physical abuse, sexual abuse, stripping, obscene acts, or bodily harm.	Expulsion from University and debarring from other institutions; fine up to Rs. 1,00,000/- + **Mandatory FIR Case**.
1 (h)	Abuse via spoken words, emails, public insults, or sadistic behavior.	Debarring from exams/events; withholding results; hostel expulsion; rustication up to 4 semesters; fine up to Rs. 50,000/-.
1 (i)	Acts affecting mental health and self-confidence.	Debarring from exams/events; withholding results; hostel expulsion; rustication up to 4 semesters; fine up to Rs. 50,000/-.
1 (j)	Bullying/exclusion based on race, religion, caste, gender, identity, etc.	Debarring from exams/events; withholding results; cancellation of admission; fine up to Rs. 50,000/- + **FIR Case**.

Approved: 17 May 2019 | **Notified:** 18 May 2019
Registrar, CHRIST (Deemed to be University), Bengaluru - 560 029